



Women masons engaged in the housing reconstruction of earthquake beneficiaries after the graduation of masons training organized in Ward no. 9, Palungtar Municipality of Gorkha, organized by Government of India supported Nepal Housing Reconstruction Project in the district.

(Photo credit: Mr. Ram Sapkota, District Coordinator, Nepal Housing Reconstruction Project, Gorkha)

HIGHLIGHTS

- [HRRP Partner Satisfaction Survey](#)
- [NRA Notice on the Final Tranche disbursement deadline](#)
- [Urban Webinar on “Leadership of Municipal Government for Urban Recovery and Development”](#)
- [Workshop on NRA's Best Practices on Private Housing Retrofitting Experience and Way Forward](#)
- [Economic Impact Study](#)
- [COVID-19 live updates from Ministry of Health and Population \(MoHP\)](#)

FEATURED TECHNICAL STAFF STORY: Laxmi Pathak, Mobile Mason, Ward no 9, Manahari Rural Municipality, Makwanpur



*Laxmi Pathak,
Mobile Mason
Manahari Rural Municipality - 9,
Makwanpur*

Laxmi Pathak, Mobile Mason, Manahari Rural Municipality - 9, Makwanpur

Breaking all the gender stereotypes, Ms. Laxmi Pathak from Manahari Rural Municipality, Makwanpur district is a staff member serving NRA DLPIU Building Office as a mobile mason. Pathak started working as a mobile mason from January 2020 and is based in Ward no. 9 of the Rural Municipality.

During the initial days of the reconstruction, female masons were given less priority in the community. Pathak shared that the community used to doubt the ability of female masons, because of which the beneficiaries did not properly follow the instructions or guidance given by female masons. When villagers saw female masons like herself carrying sand, bricks, and cement to dig a foundation with confidence and aura, they also started to believe in the

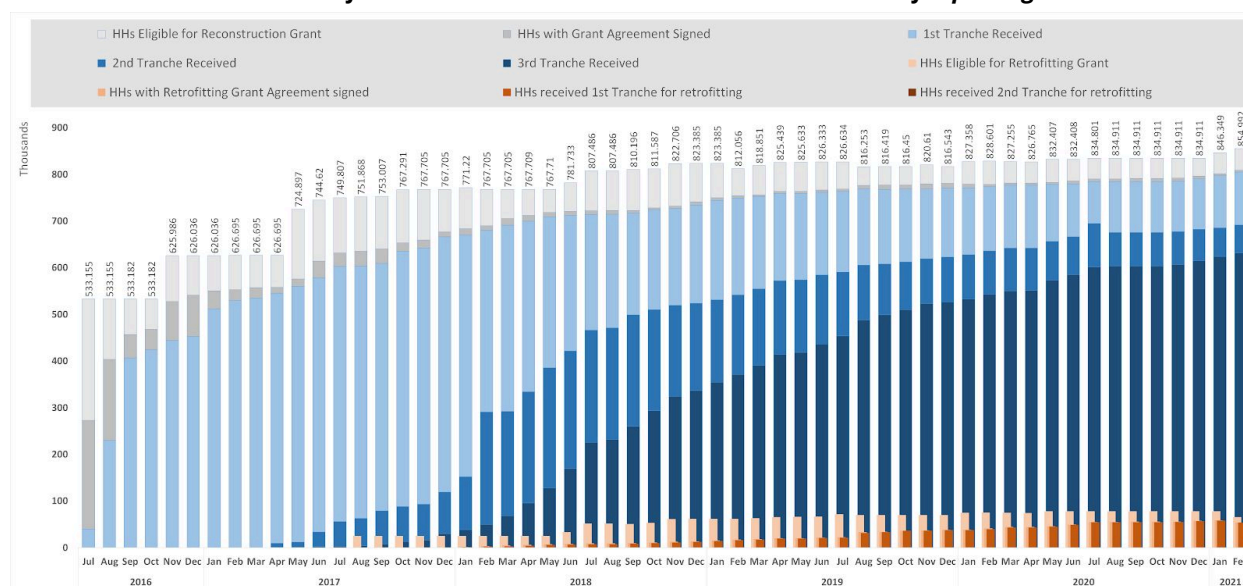
female mason's capacity like they did for male masons.

NATIONAL UPDATES

NRA, CLPIU GMAI and Building. Grant Disbursement Data, as of 22 February 2021

Reconstruction Grant	19 October	30 November	28 December	25 January	22 February
Total No. Eligible HHs	834911	834911	834911	846349	854992
HHs Enrolled	791534	791787	796282	800973	808489
HHs Received 1st Tranche	784556	785078	790266	796809	804978
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	675613	677557	681953	685600	691264
HHs Received 3rd Tranche	603555	606505	614642	624096	631203
Retrofit Grant	19 October	30 November	28 December	25 January	22 February
Total No. Eligible HHs	78033	78033	78033	64887	65162
HHs Enrolled	55282	55649	57319	54580	53795
HHs Received 1st Tranche	54497	54859	56478	54723	53728
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	302	303	332	339	368

***N/A indicates that the information source was not accessible at the time of reporting**



Progress with the disbursement of the GoN housing reconstruction and retrofit grants based on NRA GMAI CLPIU data as of 22 Feb. 2021

HRRP Partner Satisfaction Survey: The ongoing, Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform-Phase 4 (HRRP-4), (August 2019- July 2021), is supporting remaining reconstruction needs with primary focus on urban recovery, retrofitting, reconstruction of vulnerable households and localization, using reconstruction programs including documentation and sharing of lessons learnt. HRRP conducted the first round of Partner Satisfaction Survey (PSS) in August 2020 and based on the feedback, HRRP adjusted its work priorities with special consideration on capacity strengthening of local government, resumption of joint monitoring visits, supporting housing reconstruction of vulnerable households and urban recovery and reconstruction, among others. In this process, HRRP has launched the 2nd round of PSS with the objective of assessing how HRRP-4 is doing in terms of fulfilling its mandate, and perceived by the stakeholder groups involved in the Platform. We would be grateful if you could provide your feedback through this second round of PSS by **1 March 2021**. The survey can be conducted in Nepali or English language, whichever you feel comfortable with and will take approximately 5 -10 minutes to complete. If you have any queries, you can directly write to info@hrrpnepal.org

Link to the survey: **[START HRRP SURVEY](#)**

Workshop on NRA's Best Practices on Private Housing Retrofitting Experience and Way Forward

On 21 February 2021, National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) jointly with the Central Level Project Implementation Unit (CLPIU Building) with the support from UNOPS, UNDP, Build Change, NSET, CRS and HRRP organized an 'International Conference on Nepal's Reconstruction (ICNR) Workshop on NRA's Best Practices on Private Housing Retrofitting Experience and Way Forward". The program was physically and virtually attended by numerous participants consisting of researchers, academicians, technical specialists, government officials, donors and development partner representatives and civil society representatives. The participants discussed the NRA's experience on private housing retrofitting, retrofitting guidelines and manuals, norms and standards on retrofitting construction works and roster of trained human resources in retrofitting.



Urban Webinar Series # 2 – “Leadership of Municipal Government for Urban Recovery and Development”:

On 17 February 2021, HRRP together with Urban Reconstruction Technical Working Group (UR-TWG), Catholic Relief Services (CRS) & UKAID organized the second Urban Webinar Series with a theme “Leadership of Municipal Government for Urban Recovery and Development”. Urban Webinar Series is a virtual gathering for sharing learnings from Nepal’s urban housing recovery and intends to connect these learnings to longer term Nepal’s urban development visions in order to facilitate efficient, sustainable and inclusive urban settlement recovery. The Webinar Series intended to offer a platform for national and international knowledge sharing on urban housing recovery issues, best practices and success stories. In this webinar, two notable speakers - Er. Krishna Prasad Sapkota [Executive Director of Town Development Fund (TDF) -Nepa] and Mr. Noel E. Rosal (Mayor of the City of Legazpi, Philippines) shared their experiences, learnings and knowledge on the broader theme and given topics. Presenting on the topic ‘Financing Models and Project Planning for Urban Development in Nepal’, TDF Executive Director Sapkota provided a brief introduction on TDF’s business model for urban infrastructures and its priority areas. He presented various financing models and presented a case of

urban regeneration of the historic town of Dhulikhel. In the session, Er. Sapkota proposed financial models for urban recovery and potential areas of collaboration with various stakeholders. Likewise, Mayor Rosal presented on the topic 'Initiatives of Legazpi City for Good Governance & Urban Development' where he shared Legazpi city's vision on urban development and also elaborated on its inherent challenges. He highlighted that through the Comprehensive Land Use Plan (CLUP), Comprehensive Development Plan (CDP) and the ten-year plans, he is trying to overcome Legazpi city's development challenges. He elaborated on the planning process and how such plans are integrated into the municipal governance system. Mayor Rosal shared his vast experiences in governance and leading the city, stressing that governance is a shared responsibility; development is inevitable but should not compromise the welfare of people and environment; resources are limited and everyone has responsibility to do what they can. The event included a Q&A after speeches from speakers. The Webinar recording can be accessed [here](#). To know more or contribute your ideas, kindly contact Rupesh Shrestha: uco@hrrpnepal.org

Economic Impact Study: HRRP is coordinating the Economic Impact Study executed by three independent consultants, financially supported by CRS, and technically supported by NRA. The objective of this economic impact study is to do a comprehensive post-evaluation of recovery and reconstruction work within the mandate of NRA. The study aims to assess the NRA's contribution to National Gross Domestic Product (GDP), employment generation, poverty reduction, skill development and empowerment of women and marginalized communities, made during the NRA's 5-year term (2016 to 2020). So far, as part of this study, HRRP jointly with independent consultants have conducted several Focus Group Discussions (FGDs), namely in Gorkha (2 Feb), Nuwakot (1 Feb), Kavrepalanchowk (5 Feb) and in Sindhupalchowk (9 Feb). In these FGDs, a total of 91 participants (81 Male & 10 Female) including key stakeholders such as District Coordination Committee (DCC) Chiefs, Chief District Officers (CDO), District Chiefs of DLPIU-GMaLI, DLPIU-Building, DLPIU-Education, Palika Chiefs and Deputy Chiefs, representatives of Partner Organizations among others. Likewise, the consultants with the support of DLPIU Focal Engineers, are conducting a quantitative survey with a sample size of 6,000 beneficiaries in the 32 earthquake affected districts. The consultants are conducting Key Informant Interviews (KII) starting from 25 February with partners, donor

representatives, NRA senior officials and other relevant stakeholders. The consultants, with the support from HRRP, conducted an orientation on survey questions, its methodology and study design process for a total of 33 participants including DLPIU Focal Engineers (22 Male & 11 Female) and District Hub Coordinators of HRRP. During the orientation program, participants were briefed on survey questions along with mock-up exercises on the set of questions and action plan for pre-testing with 100 households in the field prior to conducting the real field survey. For more information, please contact, Mr. Sufi Mohammad Faiz: dmf.coord@hrrpnepal.org



NRA Notice on the Final Tranche disbursement deadline

According to an important notice issued by the NRA -

1. Beneficiaries who are eligible for reconstruction and retrofit grant are requested to sign the partner agreement by 15 December 2020 (end of Mangshir 2077), and receive first tranche by 30 December 2020 (Poush 15, 2077).
2. Beneficiaries who have received the first tranche must start their housing reconstruction and submit an application to the local government for verification

process by 12 February 2021 (end of Magh 2077).

3. All reconstruction and retrofitting beneficiaries must submit an application for verification process to the local level government by 14 May 2021 (end of Baisakh 2078) to access third or the final tranche.

COVID-19 live updates from Ministry of Health and Population (MoHP)

According to the Ministry of Health & Population (MOHP) [website](#) data, as of 21 February 2021, total cumulative new cases are 273,431 out of which 0.55% confirmed cases are undergoing medical treatment in isolation and 98.70% are discharged after recovery. So far, the death rate due to COVID-19 in Nepal is 0.75%. The MoHP has operationalized two call centers **1115 (from 6 am - 10 pm)** and **1133 (24 hours)** to provide counselling services regarding COVID-19 prevention and treatment.

DISTRICT & MUNICIPAL UPDATES

In **Lalitpur**, orientation on Building Code Implementation (BCI) was held on 22 January 2021 at Godawari Municipality. Orientation program was attended by technical staff of the municipality including engineers, sub-engineers, and field technicians of the Planning and Building Permit Section. HRRP plans to conduct the second and third phase of BCI training and orientation to elected officials and other senior officials of the Administration and Planning Section of the Municipality. Mr. Shivaram Gelal, Project Chief, DLPIU-GMaLI, Lalitpur, has handed over completed road projects that were constructed under Earthquake Housing Reconstruction Project (EHRP)/CLPIU GMaLI, to Mr. Gajendra Maharjan, Mayor of Godawari Municipality and to Er. Deepak Kumar Das, Office Chief of Infrastructure Development Office, Bagmati Province. NRA's Social Mobilizers and Mobile Masons in the district are providing socio-technical assistance to reconstruct low-cost feasible houses for vulnerable beneficiaries. Low-cost feasible houses for vulnerable beneficiaries are in reconstruction phase in concerned municipalities of the district.

In **Bhaktapur**, Er. Rama Maiya Manandhar has joined as Project Chief of DLPIU- Building Bhaktapur Office from mid February 2021 (Magh B.S 2077). On 10 February 2021, DLPIU -

Building organized reflection meeting for social mobilizers to review housing reconstruction progress and discuss challenges faced by them. From 1-11 February 2021, NRA engineers and M & E Consultant from DLPIU Building Office visited Palikas of Bhaktapur district periodically to discuss application conditions of houses that were built before deployment of engineers. Social Mobilizers are engaged in collecting housing reconstruction commitment from beneficiaries who have received the first tranche and they are guiding them to apply for a second tranche by mid February 2021 (end of Magh 2077). Social Mobilizers and Mobile Masons deployed in concerned Palikas are jointly providing socio-technical assistance to vulnerable beneficiaries for reconstructing low-cost feasible houses for which respective Ward offices have provided support for the required number of bricks. According to them, one week is required to build upto roof level through collective technical support approach by Mobile Masons.

In **Kathmandu**, 22 beneficiaries from Kathmandu district have returned their tranche amount. Likewise, other 28 beneficiaries, who have paid double, from Shankharapur Municipality, have been requested to return their tranche amount. To do follow-up on the return tranche, the Municipality will be doing follow-up with concerned beneficiaries. Engineers and Social Mobilizers are collecting missing partnership agreement numbers within Kathmandu district.

In **Makwanpur**, an interaction program to discuss housing reconstruction plans with all rural municipalities and municipalities of the district was completed on 27 January 2021 in the presence of DLPIUs, NRA, and relevant district stakeholders. This interaction program was chaired by the Chairperson of DCC and the Chief District Officer (CDO) as the chief guest. After the interaction program, NRA central office team members accompanied by the CDO and DCC Chair including other district stakeholders conducted a field monitoring at Ward no 4, Manahari Municipality and interacted with earthquake-affected families, who are residing in the flood-prone areas. In the field visit briefing, it was shared that there are policy issues and NRA will take immediate steps to address issues.

In **Sindhupalchowk**, GMaLI has received 25 partnership agreement requests from beneficiaries even after the deadline from NRA has crossed. The NRA team interacted with elected local bodies and local officials of all the local governments of Sindhupalchowk

district at Chautara, Sangachowkgadhi Municipality. In the interaction program, local governments shared the status of reconstruction of private housing and an action plan was prepared to complete the remaining task within the timeframe stipulated by NRA. On 25 January 2021, municipal level BCI orientation program was organized by HRRP with the presence of engineer, sub-engineer, and assistant engineers. On 9 February 2021, FGDs of the Economic Impact Study was held at an Integrated Majhi Settlement, where house reconstruction of 53 houses were completed and reconstruction of one house was on-going.

In **Nuwakot**, a facilitation meeting was organized by GMaLI on 11 February 2021. The main agenda of the meeting was to provide a clear direction for distribution of the first tranche which was requested after the last deadline set by NRA. GMaLI has also prepared and shared an action plan to complete reconstruction within an estimated time frame. Local governments of the district have also prepared an action plan in line with GMaLI's plan which is aligned with the NRA deadline and plan.

In **Kavrepalanchowk**, DLPIU GMaLI Office is managing first and second tranche inspection files based on the NRA action plan. DLPIU GMaLI is also managing vulnerability beneficiaries' details based on top-up support and doing digitization of partnership agreement numbers. DLPIU-Building is working on the hard copy file management of reconstruction beneficiaries. DLPIU-Building is also collecting beneficiaries details who have had reconstructed a new house before engineers were deployed at ward. Also, FGDs for the Economic Impact Study was completed on 5 February 2021 at Panauti Municipality in presence of Mr. Ram Prasad Khyaju, Kavre GMaLI Chief, Chief Administrative Officer of Panauti Municipality, Focal Engineers and Environment Specialist from DLPIU, Police Officers, Ward Chairperson, and some beneficiaries from Ward number 5, 6, 7, and 8 of the municipality.

In **Solukhumbu**, 10,848 beneficiaries have completed house reconstruction, where 11,323 beneficiaries received second tranche and 13,235 received first tranche. Also, 444 earthquake affected beneficiaries are delisted from NRA grant list.

HRRP District Coordination Team Bhaktapur, Lalitpur Monthly Report, 21 Jan – 14 Feb 2021



Ward 5, Changunarayan Municipality, Bhaktapur: Two rooms with BMC house and flexible roof. The house owner received the first tranche of the Government Housing Grant and has jointly applied for second tranche and third tranche together.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dolakha, Ramechhap, Sindhuli Monthly Report, 21 Jan – 14 Feb 2021



Ward 8, Kalinchowk Rural Municipality, Dolakha: The house is a single storey made up of wooden frame structure. It is an adjoining house built by two beneficiaries mutually. Homeowners have received all tranches under Government Housing Grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kathmandu Monthly Report, 21 Jan – 14 Feb 2021



Ward 22, Kathmandu Metropolitan City, Kathmandu: Six-storey RCC structure with raft foundation. The house owner has received the first tranche and has jointly requested for a second and third tranche under Government Housing Grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kavrepalanchok Monthly Report, 21 Jan – 14 Feb 2021



Ward 1, Dhulikhel Municipality, Kavre: RCC with single story two room house. House owner has received a third tranche from the Government Housing Grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Makwanpur Cluster Monthly Report, 21 Jan – 14 Feb 2021



Ward 4, Thaha Municipality, Makwanpur: Two rooms with single storey house. Brick in cement mortar. Load bearing structure with horizontal and vertical reinforcements are provided. The homeowner received all the tranches under Government Housing Grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Solukhumbu Cluster Monthly Report, 21 Jan – 14 Feb 2021



Ward 1, Khumbupasang Rural Municipality, Solukhumbu: Stone with mud mortar and wooden band is used. Homeowner has received first and second tranche from Government Housing Grant and has applied for third tranche.

HRRP District Coordination Team Rasuwa, Nuwakot Monthly Report, 21 Jan – 14 Feb 2021



Ward 2, Panchakanya Rural Municipality, Nuwakot: Stone mud mortar house with workable attic. The house owner has also received all subsequent tranches under Government Housing Grant

HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhupalchowk Monthly Report, 21 Jan – 14 Feb 2021



Ward 5, Tripurasundari Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchowk: RCC frame structure. The House owner has received all tranches from Government Housing Grant.

FEATURED STORY



Laxmi Pathak, Mobile Mason, Ward no 9, Manahari Rural Municipality, Makwanpur:

Breaking all the gender stereotypes, Ms. Laxmi Pathak from Manahari Rural Municipality is serving with the NRA DLPIU-Building as a mobile mason. Pathak, 22, started working as a mobile mason from January 30, 2020 in Ward no.9 of the Municipality in the district. Pathak is currently pursuing her Bachelor's degree. Villagers often made fun of her and doubted her ability as a mason. Because in

Nepalese society, mason is men's work and graduating students like her should be either studying or doing a high-paid job.

She adds, "Villagers talk a lot about me. But I don't get bothered by what they say and what they do". During initial days, female masons were given less priority in the community. She shares that the community used to doubt the ability of female masons, because of which they did not properly follow the instructions or guidance given by female masons. When villagers saw female mason like her carrying sand, bricks, and cement to dig a

foundation with confidence and aura, they started to believe in female masons like they trusted male masons. Housing reconstruction in her area is making good progress and almost 90% of the reconstruction is completed.

CASE STORY

Ram Mohan is going to live in a two storey building



Mr. Ram Mohan is residing in Ward no 5, Shivapuri Rural Municipality, Nuwakot district. He has constructed two storeys of a traditional building before the earthquake. His main occupation is farming on the agricultural land inherited from parents.

The 2015 earthquake destroyed his house completely. Most of the farm products collapsed. He got some support from different agencies during the response period. With the support of the agencies, he prepared a temporary shelter by using corrugated galvanized iron (CGI) sheets and some wood extracted from his collapsed house. He resided in temporary shelter for about four years and said he felt so bitter and terrible.

After enrollment from NRA, he tried for his reconstruction, but he was not able to continue it. His family depended on his income which was mainly subsistence agriculture and daily wages as rural needs in agriculture. With his income alone, it was not possible to construct a house. So, his family spent four years in a temporary shelter.

NRA has selected eight mobile masons in Shivapuri Rural Municipality. After coordination with Rural Municipality and Ward Office, his house was selected for support. Ms. Bimala Koirala, Social Mobilizer from DLPIU has claimed that eight mobile masons have worked for nearly two weeks to construct his house. Construction materials were collected locally and purchased by the owner.

Now, Ram Mohan has his own home again. He has a plan to shift into his new house before the rainy season. The team of mobile masons and social mobiliser have plans to support another six houses before July 2021.

Women Can Do! (Photo & Story Credit: Ram Sapkota, District Coordinator, Government of India Supported Nepal Housing Reconstruction Project, Gorkha)



Women masons find themselves more confident in housing construction works after successfully completing mason trainings organized for the women masons by the Government of India (GoI) supported Nepal Housing Reconstruction Project, Gorkha. Two, seven-day masons' training on earthquake resistant construction targeting women masons have been completed in Gorkha district. These trainings were

conducted in Ward 9 in Palungtar and Ward 3 in Gorkha Municipality. These trainings were organized with an objective of enhancing knowledge and skills of 20 local women masons in building earthquake-resistant houses.

Speaking at the concluding function, Sunita Shrestha, Senior Divisional Engineer/ Project Chief, DLPIU-Building Gorkha, expressed her satisfaction that the skilled women masons could play a leading role in building safe houses in the days to come via promoting their employment opportunities as housing construction champions. She further added, "I am confident about the capability of trained women masons in constructing safer houses, who would have the opportunity to work not only in the housing sector, but also in other physical infrastructure projects in upcoming days by coordinating with municipalities."

Ms. Bina Shrestha, Deputy Mayor of Gorkha Municipality and Ms. Januka



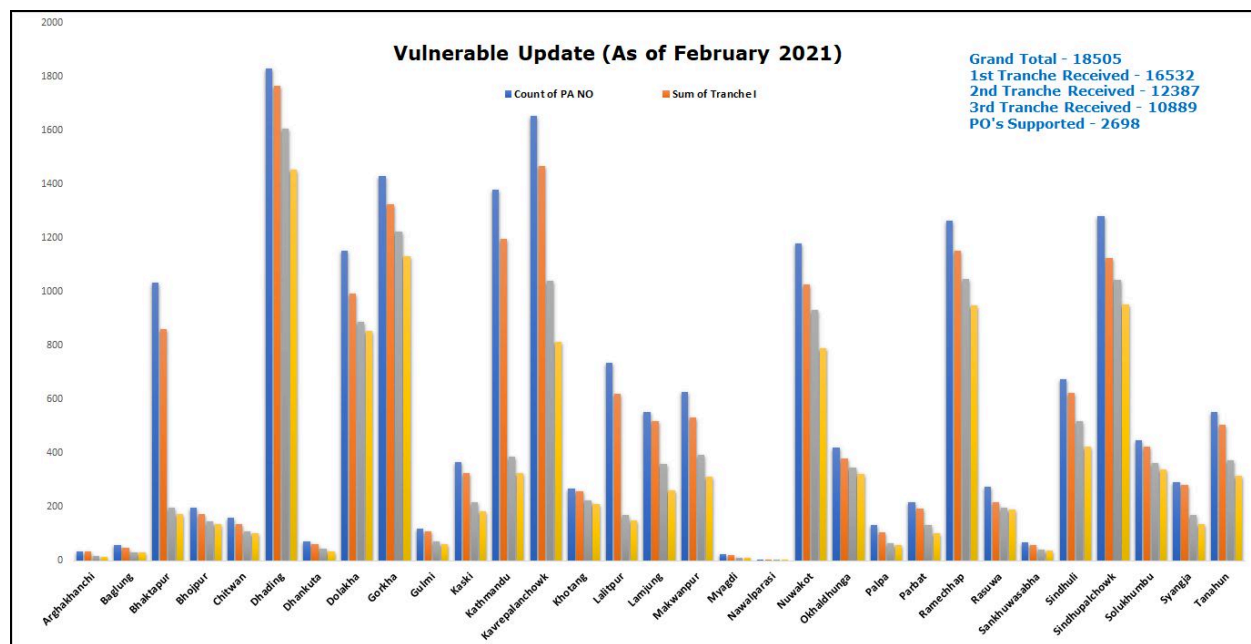
Adhikari, Deputy Chief of DCC Gorkha committed to involve the trained women masons in the development and construction works in the Municipality.

Speaking at the training closing ceremony in Palungtar, Er. Deepak Babu Kandel, Mayor of Palungtar Municipality, expressed his happiness on how these women masons were the ambassadors redefining society's traditional understanding on the role of women, and the change makers in the society. Ms. Pampha Basel, Deputy Mayor, Palungtar Municipality urged women to transform themselves through such training and make it a source of income generation, adopting construction as a profession.

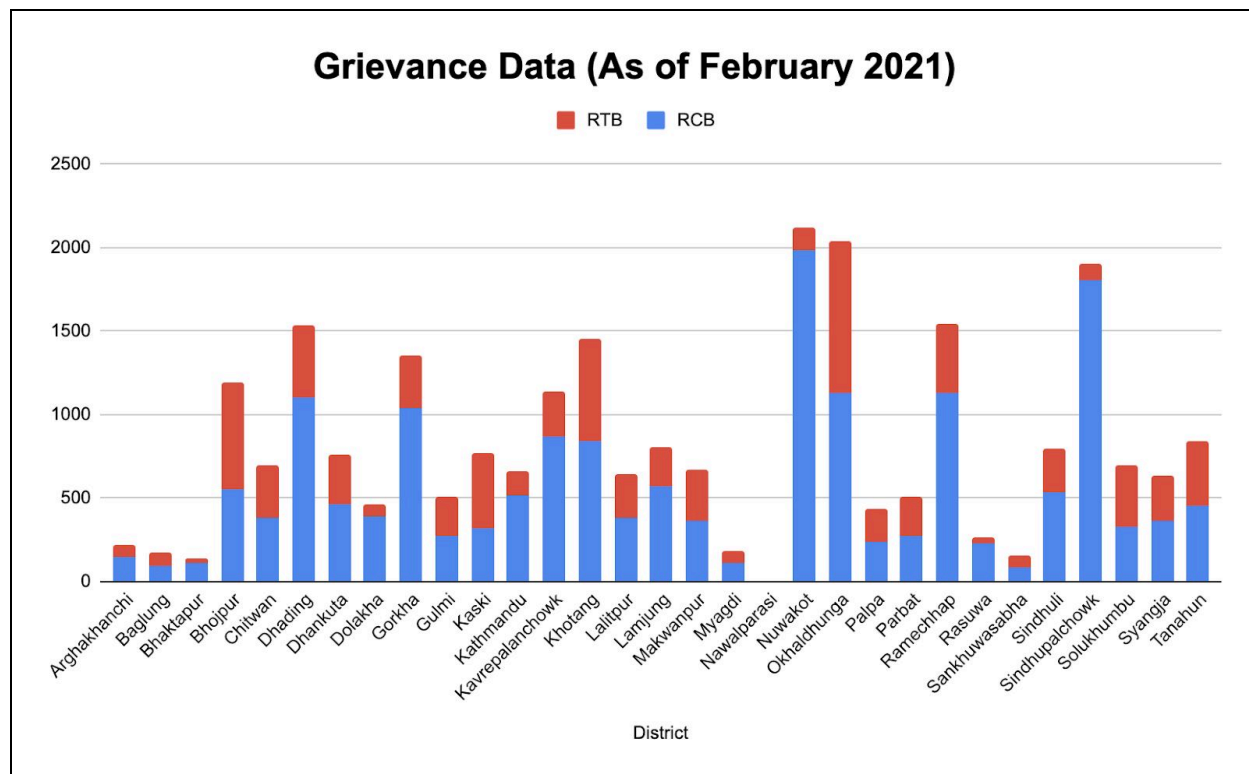
Vulnerable Households Reconstruction

Vulnerable Households Reconstruction (February 2021):

Of the total **18,505** NRA identified vulnerable households, 89% (**16,532**) have received the first tranche, 67% (**12,387**) have received the second tranche and 59% (**10,889**) have received the third tranche. In total 2,698 HHs have been supported by various partner organizations.



Grievances Data Update: As of February 2021, **25,463** grievances have been addressed by NRA, out of which **17,146** HHs have been enlisted as reconstruction beneficiaries and **8,317** as retrofitting beneficiaries.



MEDIA COVERAGE & COMMUNICATION ON RECONSTRUCTION



[Baliyo Ghar Surakshit Nepal | 15 February 2021](#): This episode focuses on issues of room and floor extension in reconstructed houses and its solution from central bodies of Government. This program airs on Nepal Television every Friday 7:00 PM and every Saturday 10:30 AM.

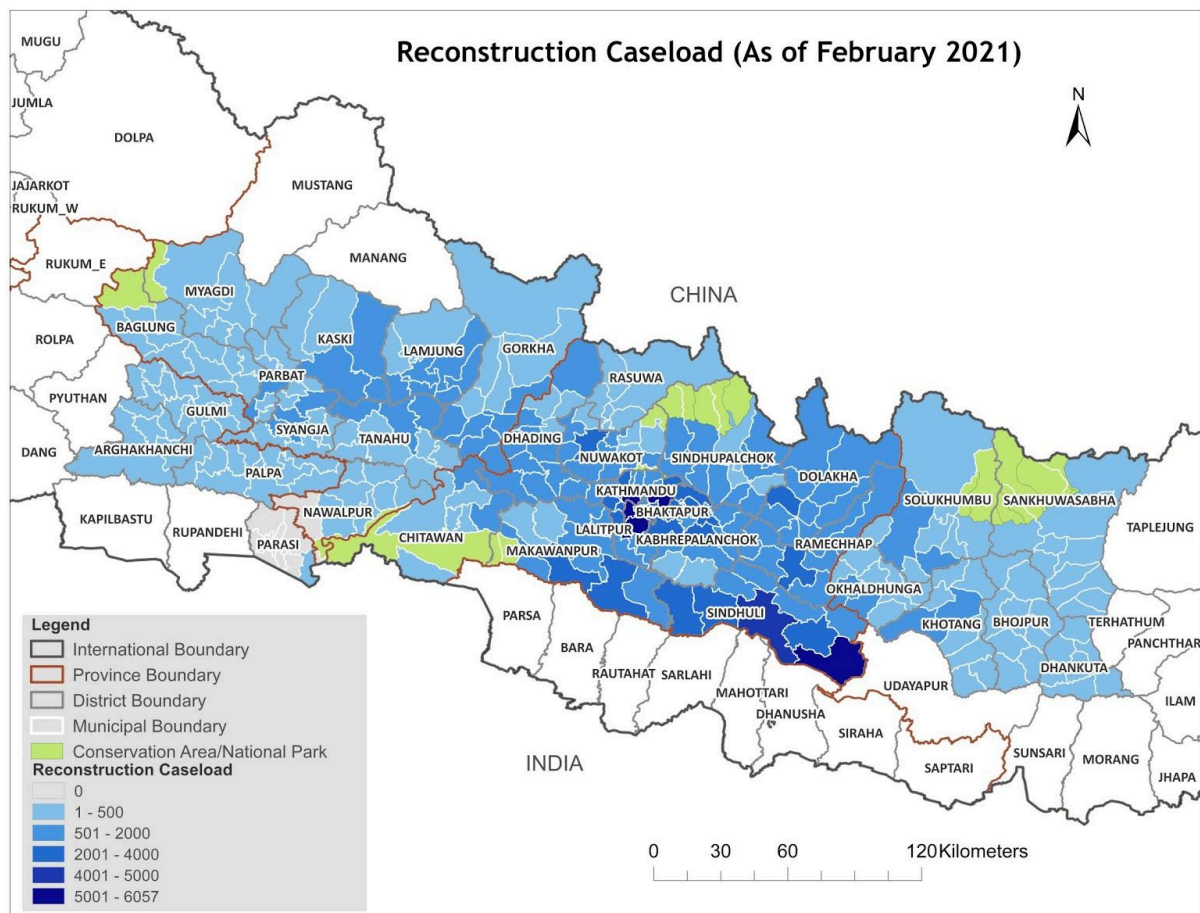
NATIONAL PRODUCTS

[Monthly e-newsletter of NRA January 2021](#)

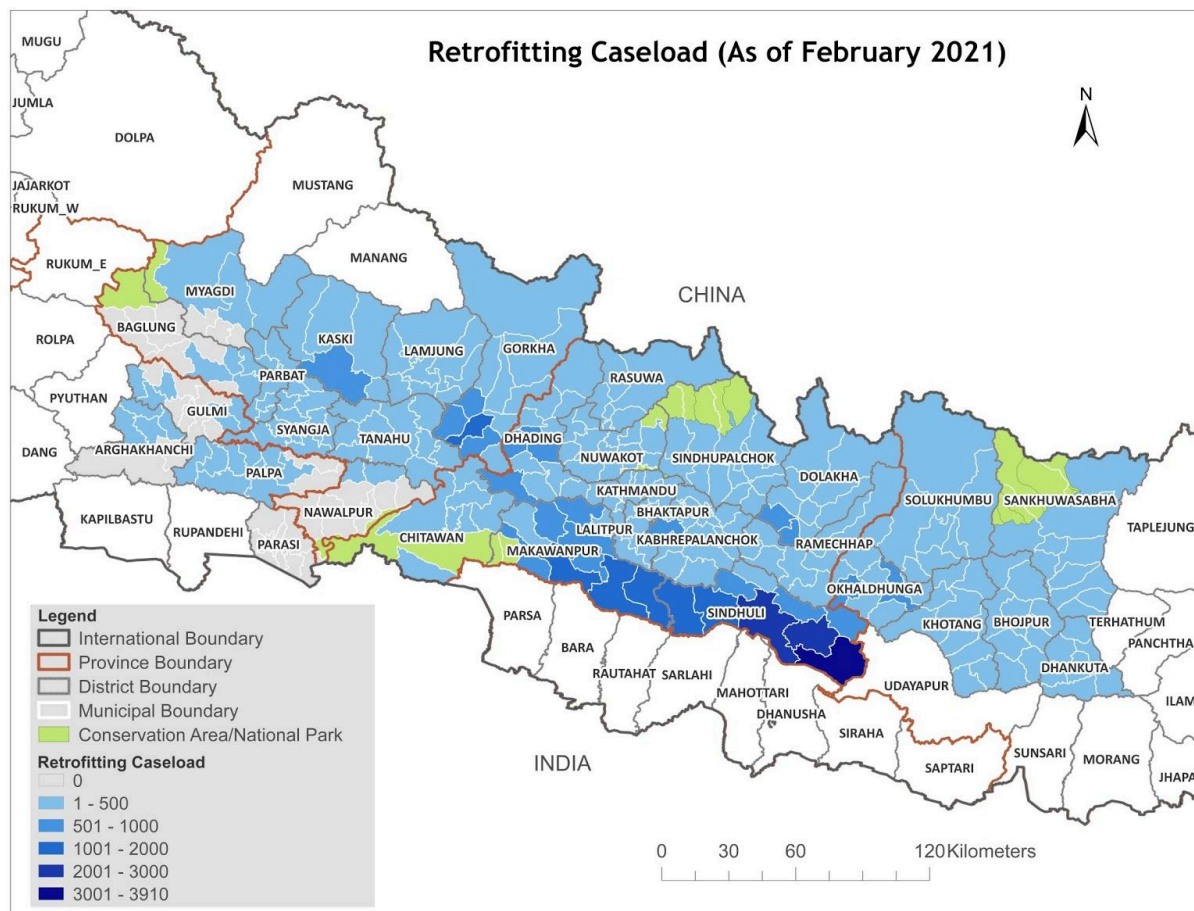
[Rebuilding Nepal, NRA publication, December 2020- January 2021](#)

HRRP PRODUCTS

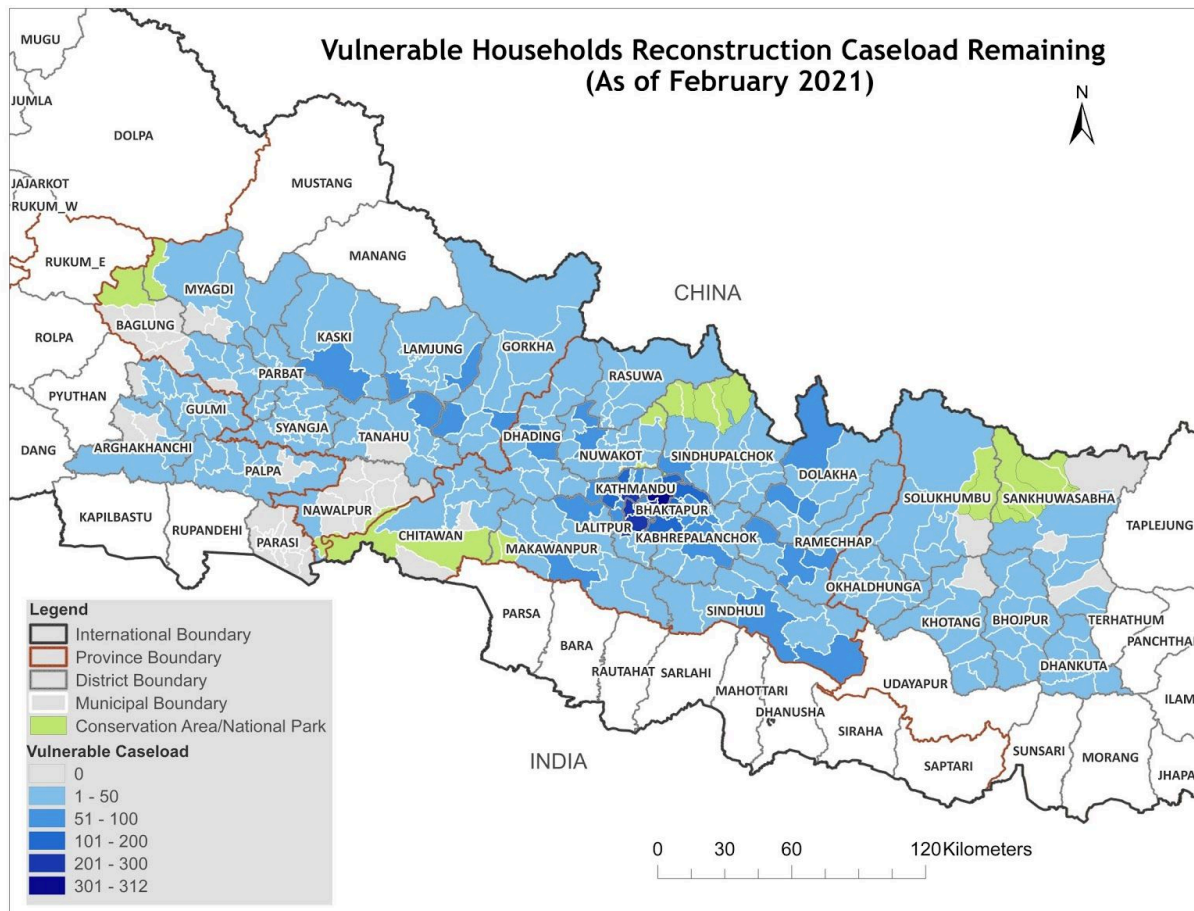
[Reconstruction Caseload Remaining \(February 2021\)](#)



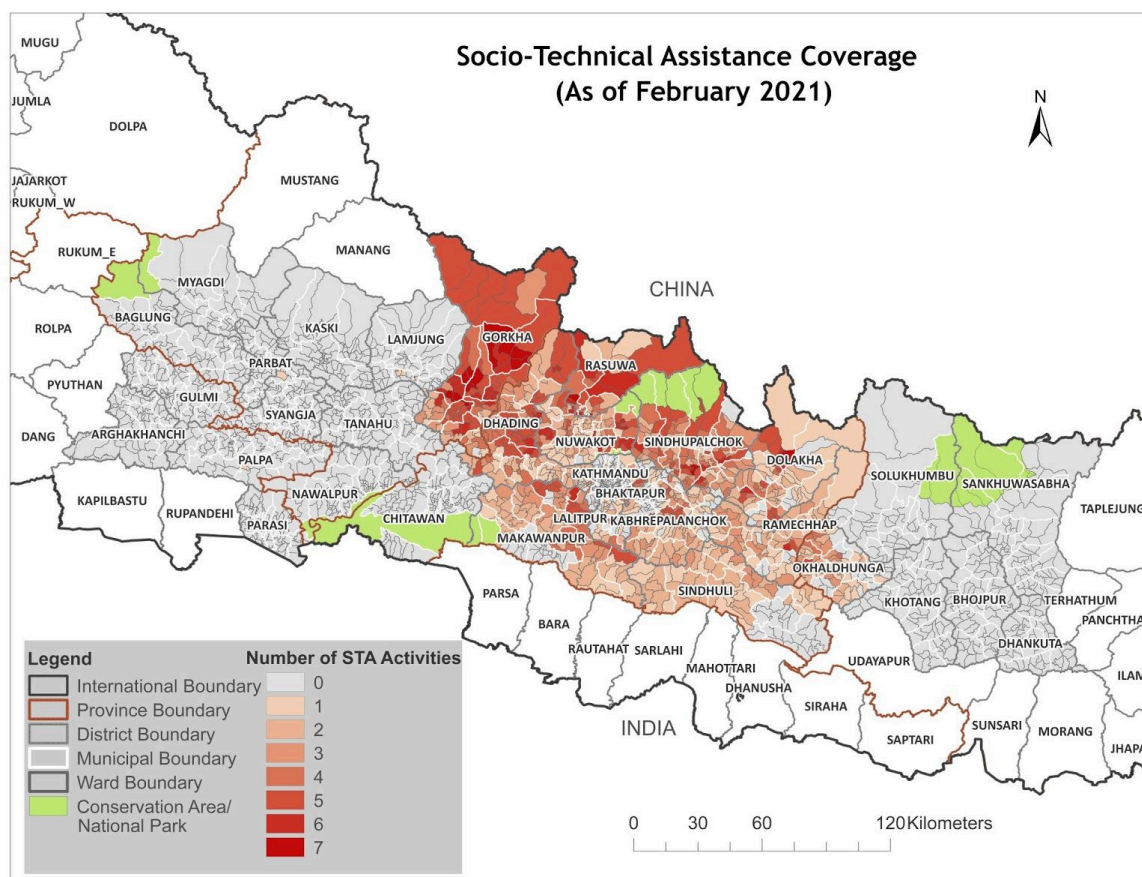
Retrofitting Caseload Remaining (February 2021)



Vulnerable Households Reconstruction Caseload Remaining (February 2021)



Coverage of Socio Technical Assistance (February 2021): This is based on 5W data collection, February 2021.



PARTNER PRODUCTS

[The Livelihood Report published by NRA:](#) The National Reconstruction Authority published the Livelihood report entitled **“The Rising from the Ruins- Experiences in Livelihood Interventions”**. This report is a compilation of technical papers submitted by the partners that have contributed in the livelihood interventions during Nepal’s reconstruction and recovery process including NRA’s effort towards livelihood resilience.



Palika Profiles (Municipal Reconstruction Profiles)

The recovery profiles contain various updates on the reconstruction and recovery at the Municipal level for all 282 earthquake-affected municipalities. The municipalities are updating the profiles on a monthly basis with technical support from HRRP.



Reconstruction and Retrofitting Information Pack

This highlights the reconstruction and retrofitting progress in all 32 earthquake-affected districts at the municipal level. This data is updated by HRRP district staff in close coordination with municipal focal persons. The links will be automatically updated to provide the reconstruction snapshot (PDF) for the month.



Municipal Dataset on Reconstruction

CSV, PDF

A composite dataset for 282 municipalities (urban status, damage grade, reconstruction, retrofitting and vulnerable HHs as identified by NRA can be assessed here as CSV and PDF). The dataset is updated by the municipalities with support from HRRP.

[FAQs](#) | [Briefing Pack](#) | [Meeting & Events](#) | [5W](#) | [Housing Progress](#) | [Housing Typologies](#)



CONTACT US

HRRP Nepal Office

Jawagal, Lalitpur, Nepal

Tel: (+977) - 01 - 5544149

Email: info@hrrpnepal.org

Primarily funded by:

